

VIJAYAKUMAR GOVINDAN

Automotive R&D Leader | EV & ADAS | Product Strategy | Project Management

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Global Automotive R&D leader with experience across APAC, EU, and North & South America. Proven in aligning engineering strategy, capital investment, and operations to business growth. Specialist in brake and chassis systems, ADAS and vehicle integration to drive innovation, and market positioning.

KEY PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Caresoft Global | First Brands Group | Stratek Consultancy

Principal Consultant Apr 2021 - Present

- Drove market penetration strategy for ADAS/Electric Vehicle technologies, aligning product positioning with customer demand, regulatory landscape, and revenue growth
- Connected with marketing, CAE, validation to drive product direction, unlocking ~15–20% cost efficiencies and differentiation
- Spearheaded chassis system global programs to drive architecture optimisation, and aftermarket strategy
- Enabled executive insights and guided 8+ CFT on EV product strategy, driving market expansion while ensuring on-time program delivery.
- Integrated ACES/PIES strategically to maximise brand positioning for both Electric / ICE vehicles by adopting SKU and inventory management

Maruti Suzuki | General Motors | Brakes India

Deputy Manager Sep 2007 - Mar 2021

- Led brake system sizing with BrakePro, managed 18+ engineers, and developed DVPR to resolve Disc Thickness vAriation (DTV) and NVH issues, ensuring project deadlines and business targets.
- Calculated, designed, and developed an indigenous low-cost DTV measuring equipment which saved a cost of \$54K
- Achieved component weight reduction by 8% and delivered \$5.4M cost savings through benchmarking and VA/VE
- Designed and implemented Floor & IP-mounted parking brake system for a sports utility vehicle (SUV)
- Analysed field & warranty issues using root-cause diagnostics, and Prototype design, thus reduced warranty claims by 34%
- Assessed ADAS and active safety features (AEB, FCW, ESC) to validate software, hardware, and vehicle integration & dynamics adoption, regulatory compliance with IS, ECE, FMVSS etc.
- Championed in IATF Audits (TS16949), Monthly Information System (MIS) on project updates to senior leaderships

Rydon Industries | Tata Motors **

Deign Engineer Jun 2004 - Aug 2007

- Engineered and released DFMEA / Computer Aided Drawings (CAD) with GD&T and Tolerance stack-up for brake / chassis system components and supported PPAP completion
- Optimised hydraulic and air brake integration through kinematic and articulation analysis, and performed DMU simulations

BUSINESS IMPACT HIGHLIGHTS

50+ Led global R&D programs

\$150M+ Budget Managed

\$5.4M+ Cost Optimisation

34% Warranty Reduction

BUSINESS AND TECHNICAL SKILLSETS

- Strategic Leadership
- Revenue Growth
- Vehicle Dynamics
- ADAS/ Vehicle Integration
- Electric Vehicle expertise
- Project / Product Management
- Brake / Chassis system design and Development

CAD AND DATA ANALYSE TOOLS

- CREO, Unigraphics , PLM
- ACES & PiES design and release
- LINK Data Acquisition
- Power BI

PROFESSIONAL CERTIFICATIONS

Design Thinking - A Primer Indian Institute of Technology	Feb 2022 - Mar 2022 Madras, India
Design for Six Sigma (DFSS) (Black Belt). General Motors	Mar 2014 - Sep 2014 Detroit, USA

TECHNICAL EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering (Automobile) Sep 2000 - Jun 2004
Government Engineering College Erode, India

INTERNATIONAL ASSIGNMENTS & VISITS

China
Assessed & Improved various brake system supplier’s design and technical capability from across china
Czech Republic
Collaborated with global brake system design & validation experts to implement best practice at ZF Technical Centre, Jablonec, Czech Republic

** Deoutated from Javem Automotives Ltd